Mecca Joint Defence Agreement (MJDA) → signed in August 2026

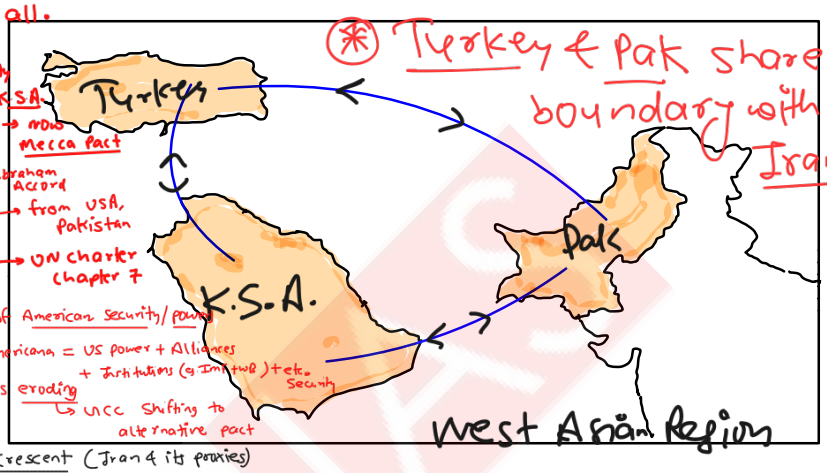
MECCA PACT

INTRO → quote → we have no eternal allies & no perpetual enemies. Our interest are eternal & perpetual. → by Lord Palmerston

CONTEXT - Saudi Arabia - Pakistan - Turkey signed a Trilateral Joint Defence Agreement in Mecca (in Aug 2025)

CONCEPTS → an attack on one is attack on all.

- → collective defence
- → Strategic hedging → reducing the risk → diversifying security portfolio → like KSA earlier USA only → now Mecca Pact
- → Security mirroring → State mirroring Security alliance of rival → like Abraham Accord
- → Security renting → UCC → rent military security → from USA, Pakistan
- → Collective security → All countries (member) act aggression → UN charter chapter 7



Turkey & Pak share boundary with Iran.

RATIONALE

- → Transition from Pax Americana (end of American security/power) → Pax Americana = US power + Alliances + Institutions (e.g. IMF, WB) + etc. → this is eroding → UCC shifting to alternative pact
- → Regional military escalation
- → Sunni solidarity (KSA + T + Pak) against Shia crescent (Iran & its proxies)

Saudi Arabia (interests)	Turkey (NATO member, Mecca Pact founder)	Pakistan
→ Securing oil infra	→ geopolitical ambition → of neo-Ottomanism, of Islamic crescent	→ economic survival → bailout, security renting
→ to counter Asymmetric warfare of Iran	→ defence industrial expansion → commercialisation	→ nuclear dimension → deterrence

DATA India → 92bn$ (SIPRI)

KSA → defence budget $ 83 bn ; 8th largest defence spender globally (SIPRI)
Tur → 2nd largest military in NATO ; defence exports $ 10bn (Annually)
Pak → conventional military - 6,60,000 active personnel

India - KSA

- → bilateral trade $43bn
- → 14% India's crude oil
- → home to 4 million Indian diaspora

CHALLENGES

Structural contradictions

- → Absence of a common enemy, economy & efficiency
- → geographical fragmentation
- → Questionable deterrence → cannot be guaranteed

Ideological → Saudi wants stability

- → Saudi - Turky rivalry ; Neo-ottoman ideology
- → divergent civil-military traditions

Financial

- → Turkey's macro-eco vulnerability → ↑ Π in Turkey ~ ≈ 30%
- → Pak's financial dependence → bailout
- → Saudi's financial capacity → limited → energy, tourism → it requires PEACE

Regional

- active proxy theaters → Saudi proxy in Libya vs Turkey proxy in Libya
- marginalisation of existing institutions → like UNCC, OIC → regional Polarisation → it indirectly strengthening → Iran's position & more dependence on U.S.A
- Iran's position → strengthening

IMPLICATIONS FOR INDIA

- Expansion of India's Conflict-Security matrix → 3 front war = Pak + China + Turkey ⊕ Now Saudi = Now four front challenge (Op Sindoor)
- Increasing Pak's strategic depth → Pak getting more Supporters
- Pakistan's diplomatic & security re-elevation → Pak getting more importance → Soln ⇒ diplomatic isolation
- Challenge to India's strategic dehyphenation → India treats West Asia → with more bilateral ties → dealing with → KSA, UAE, I2U2, Israel, Iran (dehyphenation of West Asia)
- energy security vulnerability
- Complicating IMEC → route via Saudi
- maritime challenges → Sea denial → against freedom of Navigation
- major powers and changing regional order → USA, China

Paran Balakrishnan → argued → key concern during future India-Pak conflict → how MJDA partner may intervene.

COUNTER ARGUMENTS

- Saudi is deeply risk averse → stability
- radical divergence in threat perceptions
- resilient India-Saudi relationship → 40bn $ trade, 14% oil, 4 million Indians
- 'paper-only' implementation → may fail to implement → MJDA
- regional stability benefits India

VIEWS

- Stanly Johny
- Dr. Swasti Rao → 3 E's of Security Alliance
- Gen Rahul Singh → 4 front challenge Now

LEADERS

- Rayed Krimly (minister KSA) — as per Saudi minister → agreement is not linked to nuclear ambition →
- Esmaeil Baqaei (Diplomat Iran)

SUGGESTIONS FOR INDIA

- 'Gulf Balancing' → "Gulf doctrine"
- Economic, energy & diaspora leverage
- Defence preparedness & modernisation
- Expanding naval foot-print → modernising Navy
- Global alignment → ties with Cyprus, Greece to counter Türkiye
- Diplomatic hedging → Gulf doctrine

CONCLUSION

→ deterrence by denial to deterrence by punishment

FREEBIES

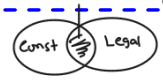
Proliferation of freebie culture has emerged as a defining feature of India's political economy. This led to transformation of constitutional obligation into a transactional aspect. (politics)

* Write Economic Survey data (Recent)

INTRO

* Context: petitions in court
  - ↳ elections → manifesto
  - ↳ institutional warnings by RBI, CS 25-26, Finance Commission

blur → freebies as not corrupt practices



DEF

: Freebies are unpaid for goods, services or UCTs funded by the state. It is usually announced before elections to induce voters. They focus on short term consumption
Eg UCT for women, free bus rides, free electricity
considered non-merit goods

"freebies for voters welfare for vulnerables"

Neo-welfarism
↳ State providing private goods to reduce multidimensional poverty.

→ welfare / merit goods - state expenditure on public goods that enhance human capabilities and long term productivity. Eg: PDS, Exp on education, health, employment

LEGAL FRAMEWORK

→ DPSP → Art 38, 39 (promotion of welfare of people)
- 39(a) → adequate means of livelihood
- 39(b) → redistribution of material resources
- 39(c) → prevention of con of wealth

→ Art 41 → Right to WORK

→ Section 123, RPA 1951 prohibits bribary in elections → it does not includes freebies as corrupt practice

→ FRL - mandates states to limit their FD - 3% of GSDP
(Fiscal Responsibility legislation)

FOR

- WELFARE VIEW → State's emp^{rc} → to enhance human capabilities → const obligation
  - ↳ welfare measures → edu + health + H.R.D.

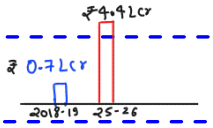
1) provides basic income → source of income → providing opportunities & (choice) → enhance "dignity"
2) women empowerment - agency
3) economic multiplier ↑ → due to increase in productivity → due to ↑ H.R.D
4) UCT is efficient delivery → DBT → no intermediaries → no corruption
5) Cash circulation → ↑ savings → ↑ investment → ↑ Govt infra

ISSUES

→ competitive populism (revdi culture) (electoral gains) ; Eg TN, MH, MP etc
→ Labharthi clientelism → Competition among politicals parties → in opportunity cost of charging high on paying class.
→ capex trade off → affecting overall devt
→ sub national bankruptcy
→ market and resource distortion
→ undermine democratic integrity
→ borne by the tax payer
→ moral hazard → someone else is bearing the cost.
→ Srcya vs Preya
→ passive beneficiaries

DATA

Economic Survey RS 1.71 LCr, (UCT women wise) 16th FC - Rs 4.14 LCr (total UCT by states)



IMP CASE

S Subramaniam Balaji v Govt of TN 2013 → SC held that freebies donot amount to corrupt practices under sec 123 of RoPA 1951

SBI → thanks to MP Ladli Behna scheme → 3.5 times more spending

QUOTES / VIEWS

→ NK Singh → freebie culture is not a road to poosperity; it is passport to fiscal digaster
→ Supreme court → Distribution of pvt goods to influence voters must be treated as corrupt practice.
→ Economic Survey → said it is easy to start a scheme but tough to close it (ES said it's a Chakravyuh)
→ Nobel Laureate
↳ Esther Duflo → her research shows that when women control more income → they invest more in their children edu & health